

When parental love is not a guiding light

In a recently released film, Mrs. on an OTT platform, a mother suggests that her daughter 'adjust' in her in-laws' home, where she is **unappreciated**, because it is socially acceptable. Her daughter cooks, cleans and takes care of her husband's family as it is her duty, only to realise that she is forgotten in **the grand scheme of things**. The film is a reminder that most of us are caught **in a bind**, trying to follow our parents' advice, fulfilling familial duties, and social **obligations**, forgetting that we are souls on a spiritual journey, and can get Home only through a spiritual **preceptor's** mentorship.

Yet another film, Three Idiots, **depicts** how parents' **intentions**, even though well-meaning, **could** be **detrimental to** children's growth. In the film, while Rancho is **epitome of liberation**, Farhan and Raju are burdened by familial expectations. Farhan wants to be a wildlife photographer, but his father forces him to become an engineer. When a child is born, parents are the first and most natural mentors – hence family comes first.

While parents are **innate** guides, their mentorship styles can sometimes **inhibit** their grown-up children's progress towards becoming a jivanmukt. Often, parents forget that their children are adults – individuals **seeking** moksh – and burden them with social obligations. Kahlil Gibran offers **wisdom** to such parents: "Your children are not your children...They come through you but not from you. They are sons and daughters of Life's **longing for** itself. And though they are with you, yet they belong not to you," he says.

In Bhagwad Gita, Krishn instructs Arjun to act **in accordance with** his role, **emphasising** Self-awareness over external **validation** for even a mother's love could be selfish. **For instance**, Mahabharat's Gandhari, mother of Kauravs, passively wanted her son Duryodhan to **succeed** as King of Hastinapur, although she didn't voice her opinion openly, but just before the final battle, she tried to safeguard her son by blessing his unclothed body. **Eventually**, Duryodhan dies, Gandhari could have stopped him, but she did not.

Ramayan's Kaikeyi had **a burning desire** to see her son Bharat as King of Ayodhya; she asked Dashrath to send his eldest son Ram into **exile** for 14 years, causing great emotional pain to Bharat.

Just as Krishn mentors Arjun, true mentors or spiritual preceptors teach their **mentee** that real wisdom **lies in** focusing on one's path while maintaining clarity of purpose and **detachment** from unnecessary obligations. Gita's verse 3.17 says, 'But one who takes **delight** in the Self alone, and is **content** in the Self only, has no duty.' In Chapter 18, Krishn makes it clear that we do not have any duties except towards one. He asks Arjun, 'To **abandon** all forms of duty and **surrender** unto Me alone. I shall deliver you from all **sinful** reactions; do not fear.'

Therefore, one must be **vigilant** against those who **preach** fulfilling one's duties and obligations towards family, society, company, nation and the world. Moms can **take a leaf out** of Maiya Yashoda's

parenting **playbook**. She raised Krishn with unconditional love and devotion, only to let him go when destiny called. We could also follow little Nachiketa's example. He **confronted** his father, Vajashrava, for giving away old and sick cows to brahmins in Kathopanishad. **Likewise**, we should stay alert on our spiritual journey and take delight in the Self alone.

Krishn also says that since no one possessing a body can entirely **give up** all actions, only he who **renounces fruits** of actions is truly called a man of **renunciation**. While our duty is towards Self-realisation alone, we must follow our dharma, **uphold cosmic** law, and renounce **doership** by performing all tasks not for our individual self, but for the One alone. **[Practice Exercise]**

- Red/blue coloring of words in the sentence indicates subject verb relationship; where 'red' denotes 'subject' and 'blue' denotes 'verb'.

Vocabulary

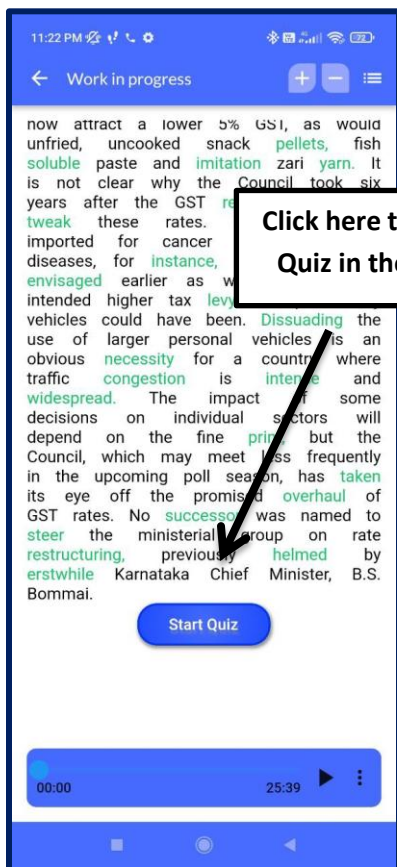
1. **Unappreciated** (adjective) – Unvalued, Ignored, Overlooked, Neglected, Undervalued अनदेखा किया हुआ
2. **The scheme of things** (phrase) – the general way that things are organized and relate to each other
3. **In a bind** (phrase) – In a dilemma, In a tight spot, In a fix, Trapped, Stuck मुश्किल में
4. **Obligation** (noun) – Duty, Responsibility, Commitment, Requirement, Burden दायित्व
5. **Preceptor** (noun) – Mentor, Guide, Teacher, Guru, Instructor गुरु
6. **Depict** (verb) – Portray, Illustrate, Represent, Describe, Show चित्रित करना
7. **Detrimental** (to) (adjective) – Harmful, Damaging, Injurious, Adverse, Destructive हानिकारक
8. **Epitome** (noun) – Embodiment, Perfect example, Quintessence, Ideal, Symbol प्रतीक
9. **Liberation** (noun) – Freedom, Emancipation, Release, Salvation, Moksha मुक्ति
10. **Innate** (adjective) – Inborn, Natural, Intrinsic, Inherent, Instinctive जन्मजात
11. **Inhibit** (verb) – Restrain, Hinder, Hamper, Restrict, Impede रोकना
12. **Seek** (verb) – Pursue, Search, Strive, Aspire, Quest तलाश करना
13. **Wisdom** (noun) – Insight, Knowledge, Understanding, Enlightenment, Discernment ज्ञान
14. **Long** (for) (verb) – Yearn, Crave, Desire, Pine, Aspire तरसना
15. **In accordance with** (phrase) – In agreement with, Consistent with, In line with, Following, As per के अनुसार
16. **Emphasise** (verb) – Highlight, Stress, Underline, Accentuate, Reinforce जोर देना
17. **Validation** (noun) – Approval, Confirmation, Endorsement, Ratification, Acceptance मान्यता
18. **For instance** (phrase) – For example, Such as, Like, As an illustration, To illustrate उदाहरण के लिए
19. **Succeed** (verb) – take over a throne, office, or other position from उत्तराधिकारी हॉना
20. **Eventually** (adverb) – Ultimately, Finally, In the end, Sooner or later, At last अंततः
21. **A burning desire** (phrase) – Intense longing, Passionate wish, Strong craving, Deep yearning, Ardent aspiration तीव्र इच्छा
22. **Exile** (noun) – Banishment, Expulsion, Deportation, Isolation, Separation निर्वासन

23. **Mentee** (noun) – Disciple, Student, Protégé, Learner, Follower शिष्य
24. **Lie** (in) (verb) – Reside, Exist, Rest, Dwell, Be situated निहित होना
25. **Detachment** (noun) – Disengagement, Separation, Indifference, Aloofness, Renunciation वैराग्य
26. **Delight** (noun) – Joy, Pleasure, Happiness, Bliss, Satisfaction आनंद
27. **Content** (noun) – Satisfaction, Fulfillment, Happiness, Peace, Gratification संतोष
28. **Abandon** (verb) – Renounce, Relinquish, Forsake, Desert, Give up त्यागना
29. **Surrender** (verb) – Yield, Submit, Relinquish, Give in, Capitulate समर्पण करना
30. **Sinful** (adjective) – Wicked, Immoral, Unrighteous, Evil, Impure पापी
31. **Vigilant** (adjective) – Watchful, Alert, Attentive, Cautious, Observant सतर्क
32. **Preach** (verb) – Advocate, Propound, Teach, Urge, Exhort उपदेश देना
33. **Take a leaf out of someone's book** (phrase) – Follow someone's example, Emulate, Imitate, Copy, Learn from किसी के उदाहरण से सीखना
34. **Confront** (verb) – Face, Challenge, Address, Tackle, Oppose सामना करना
35. **Likewise** (adverb) – Similarly, In the same way, Equally, Correspondingly, Also उसी तरह
36. **Give up** (phrasal verb) – Abandon, Relinquish, Renounce, Quit, Surrender छोड़ देना
37. **Renounce** (verb) – Abandon, Relinquish, Reject, Forsake, Give up त्यागना
38. **Fruit** (noun) – Result, Outcome, Consequence, Product, Reward फल
39. **Renunciation** (noun) – Abandonment, Rejection, Relinquishment, Sacrifice, Surrender त्याग
40. **Uphold** (verb) – Maintain, Support, Preserve, Defend, Sustain बनाए रखना
41. **Cosmic law** (noun) – universal principles or rules that govern the order, harmony, and interconnectedness of the universe and the beings within it, often encompassing spiritual and metaphysical concepts
42. **Doership** (noun) – Agency, Responsibility, Ownership, Accountability, Control कर्तृत्व

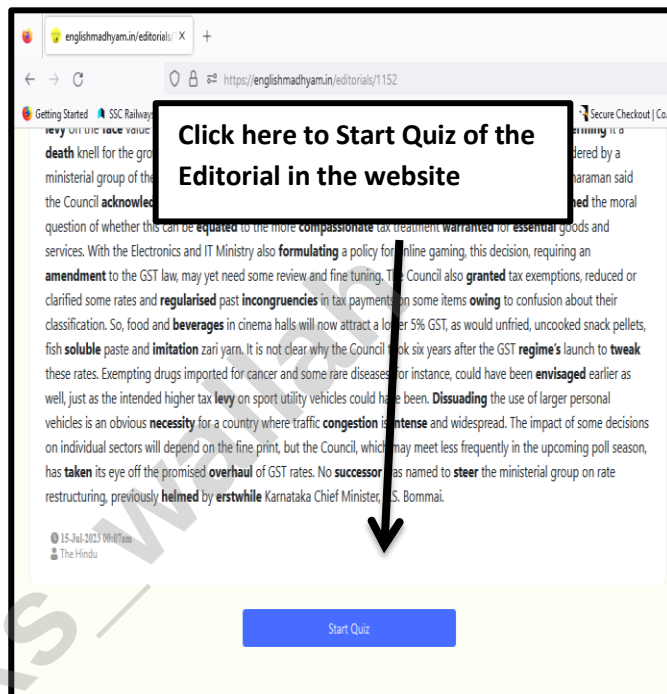
Summary of the Editorial

1. The film *Mrs.* highlights societal pressures on women to "adjust" in oppressive situations, often at the cost of their individuality and happiness.
2. Parents' advice, while well-meaning, can sometimes lead to sacrificing personal growth and spiritual journeys.
3. *Three Idiots* illustrates how parental expectations, like forcing a child into engineering, can stifle their true passions and potential.
4. Parents are natural mentors, but their guidance can sometimes hinder children's path to self-realization (jivanmukt).
5. Parents often forget that their adult children are individuals seeking moksh (liberation) and burden them with societal obligations.
6. Kahlil Gibran's wisdom reminds parents that children are independent souls, not possessions, and belong to life's longing for itself.
7. The Bhagavad Gita emphasizes Self-awareness over external validation, even from a mother's love, which can sometimes be selfish.
8. Gandhari's passive support for Duryodhan in the Mahabharata shows how parental love can enable destructive paths.
9. Kaikeyi's desire for her son Bharat to become king in the Ramayana led to emotional pain and disruption, highlighting the dangers of selfish parental ambitions.
10. True mentorship, like Krishna's guidance to Arjuna, focuses on clarity of purpose and detachment from unnecessary obligations.
11. Gita's verse 3.17 teaches that delighting in the Self alone frees one from external duties.
12. Chapter 18 of the Gita emphasizes surrendering all duties to the Divine, as the only true obligation is toward Self-realization.
13. Parents and society often impose duties and obligations, but one must remain vigilant and prioritize spiritual growth.
14. Maiya Yashoda's unconditional love for Krishna, followed by letting him go, serves as an ideal example of selfless parenting.
15. Nachiketa's courage in questioning his father in the Kathopanishad inspires individuals to stay alert and prioritize their spiritual journey over societal expectations.
16. Krishna advises renouncing the fruits of actions, performing duties not for the self but for the Divine, upholding dharma while focusing on Self-realization.

Practice Exercise: SSC Pattern Based



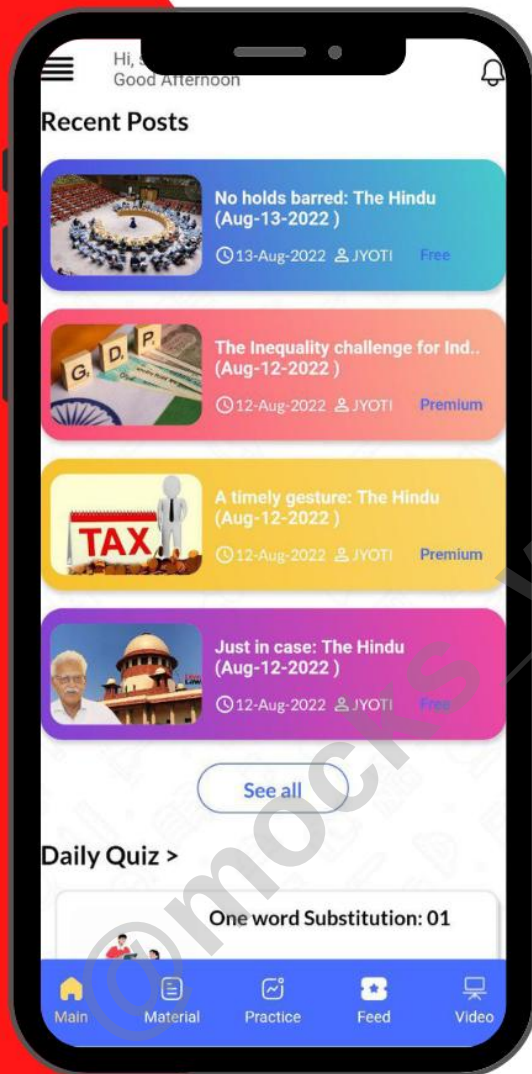
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